

Ryan Chladek

Software Engineer
Chicago, IL

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Summary

Full-stack Software Engineer with 5+ years building high-traffic travel products at scale, combining deep technical execution with product thinking across ML/AI integration, architectural migrations, and experimentation infrastructure.

Skills & Tools

Skills: Full-stack (React, TypeScript, Kotlin, GraphQL, gRPC & REST APIs), ML/AI Integration, A/B & Multi-Armed Bandit Testing, Experimentation Design, Performance Optimization, CI/CD

Tools: GitHub, Jira, Confluence, Claude Code, Cursor, ChatGPT Codex

Experience

Software Engineer II

July 2021 - Present

Expedia Group, Chicago, IL

- Won an Expedia Hackathon by engineering a visual regression testing tool, deployed as a GitHub Action, that automatically detects UI regressions on every PR and prevents unintended UX changes from reaching production
- Integrated Expedia's multi-armed bandit experimentation platform into the lodging stack via Kotlin & GraphQL, enabling dynamic content optimization across millions of user sessions and driving measurable engagement improvements
- Led front-end and API migrations for a high-traffic lodging application, refactoring legacy services to a React, GraphQL & Kotlin architecture in close partnership with cross-platform teams, reducing technical debt while maintaining full feature parity
- Migrated the lodging recommendations carousel from a sunsetted service to a new configurable architecture, cutting LCP load time from 4-5s to ~1s through a full-stack API integration and UI rebuild

Product Manager III

April 2024 - October 2024

Expedia Group, Chicago, IL

- Planned, facilitated & released lodging recommendation feature on Expedia & Hotels.com which accounted for over \$3m in annual gross profit
- Created product roadmap & kicked off tiger team to migrate Expedia's mobile app stack to a more efficient architecture, leading to improved build times for mobile app development & lowered loading times for major shopping pages on the Expedia, Hotels.com, & Vrbo mobile app by 50%
- Managed relationships with major ML & AI stakeholders to ensure alignment on product development, roadmap, & strategy
- Created & led a small crafts team to accelerate testing with the goal to meet quarterly conversion target, which resulted in a 54% increase in QoQ test velocity and a 71% test win rate

Software Engineer I

January 2021 - May 2021

Kalderos, Chicago, IL

- Wrote unit & integration tests in order to contribute to the code base regarding testing & code reliability
- Scripted data ingestion software using Python to lessen load on downstream services within the stack
- Enhanced the front-end of a greenfield pharmaceutical management system project using React

Education

The University of Iowa, Iowa City, IA
B.A. Computer Science

August 2015 - May 2019